solutions, and I am prepared to discuss with you in a substantive way all possible approaches to them and identify such steps as would make it possible—after prompt follow up by appropriate government agencies—to make my visit to the United States a really productive and fruitful one. This is exactly what the entire world is expecting from a second meeting between the leaders of the Soviet Union and the United States. I look forward to an early reply.

Respectfully,
M. Gorbachev
Sept. 15, 1986

I told Shevardnadze I wouldn't respond to Gorbachev's proposal until Daniloff was free, and in a speech to the UN General Assembly the following week, I said some strong things about his arrest as well as Soviet activities in Afghanistan and elsewhere. I half expected the Communist delegations to walk out, but none did. Meanwhile, the tug-of-war over Daniloff continued, as I recorded in these excerpts from the diary:

Sept. 24

George Shultz and Shevardnadze at the UN still dickering about Daniloff. It's getting more apparent that it's the Soviets who are blinking. We're getting closer. The Soviets don't call him a spy anymore. They refer to him as an "American citizen."

Sept. 25

. . . George Shultz [called from New York] about Daniloff and meetings with Shevardnadze; a deal cooking would have Daniloff free—and Zakharov free in exchange for [Yuri] Orlov and others if possible. I think we'll have to settle for Orlov but I recommend only if